

PLAY & LEARN ACTIVITY GAMES



Match the Emotion to the Situation

A Scenario-Matching Game for Emotional Literacy

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 5-19 - Scenario-matching game

Cut-out cards, sorting mats, games & role-play

Home - Classroom - Group activities

How to Play & Learn

This activity book turns learning into play. Print the pages, cut out the cards along the dashed lines, and use the mats and games again and again. Playing the same game more than once is where the learning sticks.

Builds emotional literacy by matching feelings to the situations that cause them - naming emotions is the first step to managing them.

Tips for grown-ups

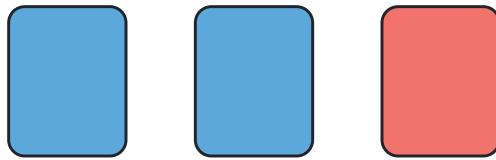
- ☐ Print on card stock if you can, so the cut-out cards last longer.
- ☐ Cut out the cards together along the dashed lines - it builds fine-motor skills.
- ☐ Play each game more than once; repetition is where the learning sticks.
- ☐ For older kids, ask 'why?' after every answer to deepen thinking.
- ☐ Keep it playful - praise trying, not just getting it right.

Ages 5-19: how it grows

- ☐ Younger (5-9): match, sort, and color with hands-on cards.
- ☐ Middle (10-13): play the games and explain WHY each answer fits.
- ☐ Older (14-19): use the discussion and reflection prompts to go deeper.

What's Inside

- 1 Emotion Cards
- 2 Situation Cards
- 3 Scenario Matching Game
- 4 Emotion Faces Sort
- 5 What Would Help?
- 6 Answer Key
- 7 Certificate



Part 1: Emotion & Situation Cards

Cut them out and find the matches.

Emotion Cards (Set 1)

Match to a situation card.

Cut along the dashed lines.

1 Happy

How does it feel?

2 Sad

How does it feel?

3 Angry

How does it feel?

4 Scared

How does it feel?

5 Excited

How does it feel?

6 Nervous

How does it feel?

Emotion Cards (Set 2)

Cut along the dashed lines.

1**Proud**

How does it feel?

2**Jealous**

How does it feel?

3**Embarrassed**

How does it feel?

4**Grateful**

How does it feel?

5**Lonely**

How does it feel?

6**Surprised**

How does it feel?

Situation Cards

Cut along the dashed lines.

1**You get a surprise gift**

Which emotion fits?

2**Your pet is sick**

Which emotion fits?

3**Someone breaks your toy on purpose**

Which emotion fits?

4**You have to speak in front of the class**

Which emotion fits?

5**You finish a hard puzzle by yourself**

Which emotion fits?

6**You're home alone and hear a strange noise**

Which emotion fits?

MATCH

Match Emotion to Situation (1)

Draw a line from each situation to the emotion it might cause.

- | | |
|--|---|
|  You get a surprise gift | Sad  |
|  Your pet is sick | Angry  |
|  Someone breaks your toy on purpose | Proud  |
|  You have to speak in front of the class | Scared  |
|  You finish a hard puzzle by yourself | Excited  |
|  You're home alone and hear a strange noise | Nervous  |

MATCH

Match Emotion to Situation (2)

Match each situation to the feeling it might cause.

- | | |
|--|---------------|
| ● A friend won't share and you wanted it too | Embarrassed ● |
| ● You trip in front of everyone | Grateful ● |
| ● Someone helps you when you needed it | Happy ● |
| ● You have no one to play with | Surprised ● |
| ● You win first place | Jealous ● |
| ● A loud clap surprises you | Lonely ● |

What Would Help?

Big feelings are okay. For each feeling, write one thing that could help. Older kids can name a healthy coping skill.

When I feel angry, it helps to...

When I feel nervous, it helps to...

When I feel sad, it helps to...

When I feel jealous, it helps to...

Answer Key

For grown-ups: here are suggested answers. Many activities have more than one good answer - use these as a guide and talk through the child's thinking.

1. You get a surprise gift -> Excited
2. Your pet is sick -> Sad
3. Someone breaks your toy on purpose -> Angry
4. You have to speak in front of the class -> Nervous
5. You finish a hard puzzle by yourself -> Proud
6. You're home alone and hear a strange noise -> Scared

Playing & Learning Journal

- Which game did you play the most?

- What was tricky at first but got easier?

- What do you want to try next?

What I Learned

- My favorite game in this book was...

- One new thing I learned was...

DRAW IT

Draw Your Own

- Draw or design your own card or game for this topic.

Talk About It

- What did this book make you think about?

- How could you use it with a friend or family member?

What I Learned

- My favorite game in this book was...

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CERTIFICATE OF LEARNING

Proudly awarded to

(write your name)

for learning to name feelings and match them to situations!